

PLAY & LEARN ACTIVITY GAMES

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Kind or Unkind Words?

A Sorting and Discussion Game for Social Skills

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 5-19 - Sorting and discussion game

Cut-out cards, sorting mats, games & role-play

Home - Classroom - Group activities

How to Play & Learn

This activity book turns learning into play. Print the pages, cut out the cards along the dashed lines, and use the mats and games again and again. Playing the same game more than once is where the learning sticks.

Builds social skills by sorting words and phrases into kind and unkind, discussing how words affect others, and practicing kinder ways to speak.

Tips for grown-ups

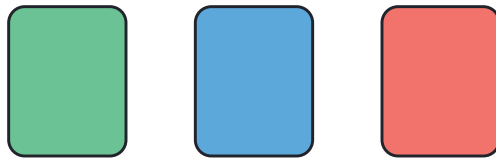
- ☐ Print on card stock if you can, so the cut-out cards last longer.
- ☐ Cut out the cards together along the dashed lines - it builds fine-motor skills.
- ☐ Play each game more than once; repetition is where the learning sticks.
- ☐ For older kids, ask 'why?' after every answer to deepen thinking.
- ☐ Keep it playful - praise trying, not just getting it right.

Ages 5-19: how it grows

- ☐ Younger (5-9): match, sort, and color with hands-on cards.
- ☐ Middle (10-13): play the games and explain WHY each answer fits.
- ☐ Older (14-19): use the discussion and reflection prompts to go deeper.

What's Inside

- 1 Word Cards to Cut Out
- 2 Kind vs. Unkind Sorting Mat
- 3 Sort & Discuss
- 4 Turn Unkind Into Kind
- 5 What Would You Say?
- 6 My Kind Words Journal
- 7 Certificate



Part 1: Word Cards

Cut out the word cards and sort them.

Word Cards (Set 1)

Sort onto the kind/unkind mat.

Cut along the dashed lines.

1 "Great job!"

Kind or unkind?

2 "Can I help you?"

Kind or unkind?

3 "I'm sorry."

Kind or unkind?

4 "You can play too."

Kind or unkind?

5 "Thank you."

Kind or unkind?

6 "I like your idea."

Kind or unkind?

Word Cards (Set 2)

Cut along the dashed lines.

1

"Go away!"

Kind or unkind?

2

"You're stupid."

Kind or unkind?

3

"That's dumb."

Kind or unkind?

4

"You can't play."

Kind or unkind?

5

"I don't care."

Kind or unkind?

6

"It's all your fault."

Kind or unkind?

SORT

Sorting Mat: Kind vs. Unkind Words

Sort your cut-out word cards into the two bins.

Kind Words

Unkind Words

Sort the cut-out cards into the right bin. Use the word cards from the previous pages.

SORT

Sort & Discuss

Write 'K' or 'U'. Then talk: how would each word make someone feel?

Kind

Unkind

"You did it!"

"Nobody likes you."

"Want to share?"

"You're too slow."

"Let me help."

"That was silly of you."

Talk about it:

Turn Unkind Into Kind

Rewrite each unkind thing in a kind way. For older kids: talk about how to disagree respectfully.

Unkind: "You can't sit here." Kind: _____

Unkind: "That's a dumb drawing." Kind: _____

Unkind: "Hurry up, you're too slow!" Kind: _____

Unkind: "Go away." Kind: _____

What Would You Say?

Match each situation to kind words you could say.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| ● A friend is new and feels shy | "Want to play with us?" ● |
| ● Someone drops their tray | "I see it differently - can I share?" ● |
| ● A classmate did well | "Let me help you." ● |
| ● You bump into someone | "I'm here for you." ● |
| ● You disagree with an idea | "Great job!" ● |
| ● A friend is sad | "I'm sorry, are you okay?" ● |

Answer Key

For grown-ups: here are suggested answers. Many activities have more than one good answer - use these as a guide and talk through the child's thinking.

1. Kind words -> Great job, Can I help, I'm sorry, You can play too, Thank you, I like your idea
2. Unkind words -> Go away, You're stupid, That's dumb, You can't play, I don't care, It's your fault
3. Reframe idea -> 'You can't sit here' -> 'There's room over here for you'

Playing & Learning Journal

- Which game did you play the most?

- What was tricky at first but got easier?

- What do you want to try next?

What I Learned

- My favorite game in this book was...

- One new thing I learned was...

DRAW IT

Draw Your Own

- Draw or design your own card or game for this topic.

Talk About It

- What did this book make you think about?

- How could you use it with a friend or family member?

What I Learned

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CERTIFICATE OF LEARNING

Proudly awarded to

(write your name)

for choosing kind words!